

SOCIOLOGY 101 · RECITATION HOMEWORK

Homework 2: Who Gets Care?

Name: _____

Date: _____

Instructions: About 20 minutes. Turn counts into rates before you compare anything – that's the whole skill. The fieldwork at the end needs a grown-up and a map. Total: **22 points**.

Part A — Counts into rates

1. Three made-up countries. Work out each one's preterm **RATE** as a number out of 100 (a percent). Preterm $\div$ births $\times$ 100. (2 points per row: 1 for the division set up, 1 for the answer.) (6 pts)

Country	Babies born	Born preterm	Rate (per 100)
A	1,000	160	
B	3,000	300	
C	500	30	

2. Which country has the **MOST** preterm babies, and which has the **HIGHEST** preterm rate? (1 pt)

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- A. B has the most babies (300); A has the highest rate (16 per 100).
 B. A has the most babies (160); B has the highest rate (10 per 100).
 C. B has both the most babies and the highest rate.
 D. A has both the most babies and the highest rate.

Part B — Per thousand

3. In one region, 5,000 babies were born last year and 28 died before their first birthday. What is the infant death rate per 1,000? (Deaths $\div$ births $\times$ 1,000.) Compare it with about 4.5 for white babies and about 10.9 for Black babies in the US: which is it closer to? (3 pts)

Part C — The map

Three towns. Riverton has a Level I nursery (healthy newborns only), 20 minutes from the Okafor family. Hillsdale has a Level II unit (a little early, a little sick), 1 hour away. The city has a Level IV NICU (everything, including surgery), 3 hours away. Mrs. Okafor is 27 weeks pregnant and her doctor thinks the baby may come in the next few days.

4. Using regionalization from last week, where should Mrs. Okafor be – and when should she go? What is the danger of waiting until the baby is born? What could the region do so families like hers don't face a 3-hour drive? (3 pts)

Part D — Social determinants

5. Draw a line from each family's situation to the social determinant it is. (4 pts)

No hospital within two hours	Money and food
Skipping meals to pay rent	Distance to care
Feeling ignored at every clinic visit	Stress
Working nights and days with no rest	Being listened to (respect)

Part E — Flashbacks

6. From NICU Tutor: where incubators are scarce, what do doctors teach instead, and why does it work? (1 pt)

7. From last week's Sociology: which level of newborn unit does complex surgery? (1 pt)

Part F — Think like a doctor

8. You run a small hospital in a poor country. Tonight you have two working incubators and ten premature babies. Using Psychology (last week and today's flashback), Physics (bubble CPAP from Week 1), and today's Sociology, what would you do — tonight, and next year? (3 pts)

HOME LAB (optional, not graded): Fieldwork: how far is your NICU?

You need: a grown-up, a map app or website, and about ten minutes

1. With a grown-up, find the nearest hospital to your home that has a NICU (try searching 'Level III NICU near me'; hospital websites usually say their level).
2. Write its name, the distance, and the drive time.
3. Now find the nearest hospital that delivers babies at all. Distance and time?
4. Imagine your family lived 2 hours from both. Write one thing that would change about a preterm birth.
5. Bonus: ask a friend or cousin in another town the same question and compare.

What I saw:

Done! Professor's initials: _____

Score: _____ / 22 points

Professor's comment:
